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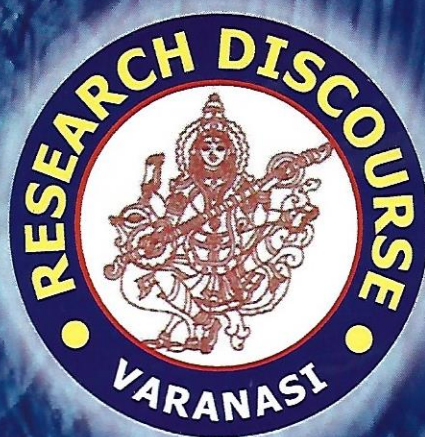
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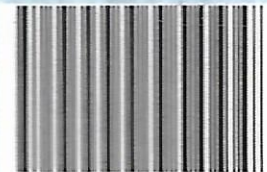
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## A Study of Environmental Moral Reasoning of Prospective Teachers

Vimal Singh\*

**Abstract :** *Earth is the only planet known to us where life is possible till now. Only till now because the way we are destroying the environment in the name of development is leading us towards our own extinction. The present study is conducted to find out the status of environmental moral reasoning among prospective teachers to know whether this factor contributes to indifferent attitude of teachers towards environment. The descriptive survey method was used to do the study by taking both male & female students of B.Ed. from both arts & science streams. Simple random sampling method was used to select the sample. The result of the study indicate as for as environmental moral reasoning is concerned female students have shown more concern as compared to male students and their mean scores differ significantly also. It means that the science stream students have more moral reasoning for environment than art stream students. This seem to reflect that more exposure to science education bring development of scientific attitude towards environment. It helps them to act wisely for environment.*

**Key Words-** Environmental Moral Reasoning, Prospective Teachers.

**Introduction :** The major issue before every human being on this earth be it policy maker, political leader, educationist, scientist, environmentalist, sociologist etc or even a common person is one and only one & that is Protection of Environment. But our environment is being depleted day by day through the misuse of scientific and technological developments and also due to lack of proper awareness regarding the environmental management.

We spend a lot of money & time in the name of environment still various issues that are haunting our life and they are different types of pollution, deforestation, wildlife depletion, desertification, global warming, ozone layer depletion, biosphere management, green house effect etc. As human beings are living in an ecosystem, where interaction of living species, non-living species, with their environment takes place so any change happens in their environment affect them. When acid rain falls over an area, it can kill trees, harm animals, fish and other wild life. It can change the chemical nature of soil and water. Even several species of plants and animals have already vanished from the earth and many are on the verge of extinction. WHO (World Health Organisation) estimates that about a quarter of diseases facing mankind today occur due to prolonged exposure to environment pollution.

Yeung (2002) said that in order to find solutions to the environmental problems, one of the prerequisites is creating changes in behaviors of people.

Many research studies have been done to identify the factors that have influence on people's environmental behavior. After identifying the research findings, it is seen that among the factors related to environmental behaviors, ethics and values are frequently highlighted. Environmental moral reasoning is one of the important aspects to find out the reason behind individual's awareness towards importance & protection of environment.

**Environmental Moral Reasoning:** Ethics are a broad way of thinking about what constitutes a good life and how to live one. They address questions of right and wrong, making good decisions, and the character or attributes necessary to live a good life. Applied ethics address these issues with a special emphasis on how they can be lived out in a practical manner. Environmental ethics apply ethical thinking to the natural world and the relationship between humans and the earth.

In the most general sense, environmental ethics invites us to consider three key propositions:

1. The Earth and its creatures have moral status, in other words, are worthy of our ethical concern;

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2. The Earth and its creatures have intrinsic value, meaning that they have moral value merely because they exist, not only because they meet human needs;
3. Drawing from the idea of an ecosystem, human beings should consider "wholes" that include other forms of life and the environment.

The above areas need considerable importance, which have already been started in many countries but in India these are still neglected aspects and this is the reason that we are still facing environment related problems.

**Need and Significance :** As we know that environmental problem is a worldwide problem and for solving this problem one's attitude, ethics, values towards environment must change. Our existence is dependent on the environment, where we live and it is the only planet so far that can support human life. We need to know how to protect our environment. We need to know what was already done to harm the environment, so that we can work to repair the damage. After public-private partnership comes in existence, in the influence of this industrialization takes place. Due to industrialization and increase in population enormous of natural resources takes place in the world. This will causes air, water, soil, and noise pollution, as a result ecological imbalance and environmental pollution taking place. If we want to minimize the environment related problems then citizens of a nation must have positive attitude towards environment. Many researches have been done with regard to environmental attitudes of students at various levels but comparatively lesser studies have been conducted where the environmental moral reasoning has also been included as a variable. Research findings clearly indicate that along with environmental attitude, environmental moral reasoning is a significant variable. Keeping this in mind the main objective of present study to find out the environmental moral reasoning B.Ed. Students.

**Objectives :**

- \* To study the environmental moral reasoning of male and female B.Ed. students.
- \* To compare environmental moral reasoning of male and female B. Ed students.
- \* To study the environmental moral reasoning of arts and science stream B.Ed. students.
- \* To compare environmental moral reasoning of arts and science stream B.Ed. students.

**Operational Hypotheses :** There is no significant difference in mean scores of environmental moral reasoning of male and female B.Ed. students when environmental moral reasoning is assessed by environmental moral reasoning questionnaire.

There is no significant difference in mean scores of environmental moral reasoning of arts and science stream B.Ed. students when environmental moral reasoning is assessed by environmental moral reasoning questionnaire.

**Operational Definitions of Key Terms :** Environmental Moral Reasoning- It is the process of determining whether an idea/action is right/wrong for environmental improvement and protection.

Prospective Teachers- In this research Prospective teachers means B.Ed. (One Year Programme) Students of University of Lucknow, Campus.

**Delimitation :** The Study was confined to the B.Ed. Students studying in University of Lucknow Campus only.

Only arts and science stream B.Ed. students were taken in this study.

**Review of Related Literature:**

**There are several reviews related to this study-** Callicott (2011). in his research paper argued that the spatial and especially the temporal scales of global climate change demand a shift in moral philosophy from a hyper- individualistic ontology to a thoroughly holistic ontology. It also demands a shift from a reason- based to a sentiment based moral psychology. Holism in environmental ethics is usually coupled with non- anthropocentrism in theories constructed to provide moral consider ability for trans organism entities - such as species, biotic communities and ecosystems. Thus the environmental ethics here present to meet the moral challenge of global climate change is holistic but anthropocentric.

Nigella (2012). in his research paper discussed that the nuclear age had a profound impact on politics and international affairs. More fundamentally, it altered the way people saw the planet and their relationship with it. This article explores these changing attitudes towards the environment within the campaign for Nuclear Disarmament (CND). At the beginning of the 1960s CND's concern about nuclear testing and fallout fit easily into the dominant anthropocentric views of the environment. However, by the end of the decade they espoused a much more holistic, even egocentric attitude.



**Method of Research :** The descriptive survey method of research was selected for this present study.  
**Population :** All the B.Ed. students of Lucknow City studying in various colleges and the University department in the session 2013- 2014 of the department of education of University of Lucknow were taken as population for this study.

**Sample And Sampling Procedure :** For the prescribed study sample was taken of all the B.Ed. students studying in Lucknow University Campus. Number of total students is 80, including male and female students. Selection of sample was done by random sampling method.

**Tools Used :** In accordance with the variable of this study, the following tool is used by investigator-

**Environmental Moral Reasoning:** Tool constructed by PROF. K. S. MISRA, University of Allahabad. This tool of environmental moral reasoning questionnaire has six categories.

**Statistical Analysis :** In this study the t-test is used for comparison purpose.

$$t = \frac{m_1 - m_2}{SE_D}$$

#### Analysis and Interpretation of Data :

**Objective- 1.** To study the environmental moral reasoning of male and female B.Ed. students.

**Table -1.0**

(Mean value showing the difference in environmental moral reasoning of male and female B. Ed students)

| GENDER | N  | MEAN  |
|--------|----|-------|
| FEMALE | 40 | 26.55 |
| MALE   | 40 | 20.5  |

From Table No 1.0 it can be seen that the mean value (20.5) of male B.Ed. students is lower than the mean value (26.55) female B.Ed. students. It reflects that the level of environmental reasoning of Male and Female B.Ed. students differs significantly.

**Objective- 2.** To compare environmental moral reasoning of male and female B.Ed. students.

**H0 1-** There is no significant difference in mean scores of environmental moral reasoning of male and female B.Ed. students when environmental moral reasoning is assessed by environmental moral reasoning questionnaire.

**Table No. -2.0**

(Mean, S.D and t value showing the difference in environmental moral reasoning of male and female B. Ed students.)

| GENDER | N  | MEAN  | S.D  | t ratio |
|--------|----|-------|------|---------|
| FEMALE | 40 | 26.55 | 1.75 | 10.25*  |
| MALE   | 40 | 20.5  | 3.3  |         |

\*Significance at 0.05 level.

On observation of the Table No. 1 it shows that the mean values of environmental moral reasoning of male and female students of B.Ed. are 26.55 and 20.5 respectively. Their standard deviations are 1.75 and 3.3 respectively. On applying t test the critical ratio was found to be 10.25 which is statistically significant at 0.05 level. Hence the null hypothesis rejected.

The result of the study indicate as for as environmental moral reasoning is concerned female students have shown more concern (mean=26.55) as compared to male students (mean=20.5) and their mean scores differ significantly also.

The finding of the present study is contrast to the above study. The probable reason for this to happen is their age level. At this the moral reasoning is based on abstract reasoning using ethical principles. So everyone has their own moral reasoning.

**Objective -3.** To study the environmental moral reasoning of arts and science stream B.Ed. students.



**Table No. - 3.0**  
(Mean value showing the difference in environmental moral reasoning of male and female B. Ed students.)

| STREAM  | N  | MEAN  |
|---------|----|-------|
| SCIENCE | 40 | 24.95 |
| ARTS    | 40 | 22.83 |

From Table No 3.0 and 1 it can be seen that the mean value (22.83) of arts stream B.Ed. students is lower than the mean value (24.95) science stream B.Ed. students. It reflects that the level of environmental reasoning of arts and science B.Ed. students differs significantly.

**Objective -4.** To compare environmental moral reasoning of arts and science stream B.Ed. students.  
**H0 2-** There is no significant difference in mean scores of environmental moral reasoning of arts and science stream B.Ed. students when environmental moral reasoning is assessed by environmental moral reasoning questionnaire.

**Table No. -4.0**  
(Mean, S.D and t value showing the difference in environmental moral reasoning of arts and science group B.Ed. students.)

| STREAM  | N  | MEAN  | S.D  | t ratio |
|---------|----|-------|------|---------|
| SCIENCE | 40 | 24.95 | 2.04 | 4.04*   |
| ARTS    | 40 | 22.83 | 2.6  |         |

\*Significance at 0.05 level.

On observation of the table no.2 it shows that the mean values of environmental moral reasoning of science and arts group B. Ed students are 24.95 and 22.83 respectively. Their standard deviations are 2.04 and 2.6 respectively. On applying t test the critical ratio was found to be 4.04 which is which is statistically significant at 0.05 level. Hence the null hypothesis no.2 is rejected.

The result of the study indicate as for as environmental moral reasoning is concerned female students have shown more concern (mean=24.95) as compared to male students (mean=22.83) and their mean scores differ significantly also. It means that the science stream students have more moral reasoning for environment than art stream students. This seem to reflect that more exposure to science education bring development of scientific attitude towards environment. It helps them to act wisely for environment. It also shows that their idea /action for our environment are better than the B. Ed students of arts stream. As their responses also show that it is their responsible to protect environment, they consider not only human beings but also animals in an ecosystem.

**Conclusion :** The conclusion of this study as follows-

The level of environmental moral reasoning in female students is significantly higher than male students.

The level of environmental moral reasoning of Science stream students is significantly higher than arts stream students.

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